

Microsoft Research India has initiated a pilot project with Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU) for a MOOC-ish experiment. They are offering free online certification for Algorithms, Design and Analysis for engineering students in a setting that combines the classroom and the online. It is a semester long program and the top ten students get a chance to intern with Microsoft Research.

MOOCs have been proven to give quality education in terms of curriculum and content. They are comparable even with degree courses.

College Transfer Credits

In high school, there are Advanced Placement (A.P.) courses that offer college level placement and course credit. These help you get a head start on college while saving on college tuition. For those who are not in high school and still want to avail these credits, MOOCs provide a convenient solution.

In 2012, Colorado State University started offering full transfer credit for students who have completed the free introduction to the computer sciences course offered by Udacity. This was the first time a college in the United States started offering credit for a course on Udacity although several universities in Austria and Germany already did.

The American Council on Education's College Credit (ACE CREDIT) has evaluated and recommended college credit for many courses on Coursera and Udacity. Students who successfully complete these courses can request a transcript with credit recommendations from the ACE which they can then present to the college of their choice for prerequisite or undergraduate credit consideration.

In 2013, a company called Academic Partnerships started an initiative called MOOC2Degree. It enables students to earn credit for a MOOC and then apply it to a degree at one of their partner institutions. One of its institutions is the Arlington College of Nursing, University of Texas.

Open Education Alliance

Across the industry, a bunch of employers and educators have come together to form the Open Education Alliance to provide certain services to students. These services are in the form of courses or 'Nanodegrees' on the latest technology trends and relevant higher education courses. They aim to bridge the gap between the skills desired in the industry today and what is being taught in traditional universities. Sebastian Thrun, the founder